

Proposal for Emoji: Kidney

Submitter: Shuhan He; Edgar Lerma; Caitlyn Vlasschaert; Jade M. Teakell; Harish Seethapathy; Jarone Lee; Danielle Miller; Timur Erk

Main point of contact: Shuhan He

Date: 2026-07-27

Required Example Images

Size	Color	Black and white
18x18		
72x72		

Image Rights

The color and black-and-white example artwork was created for this proposal from its original vector source. It contains no third-party artwork, logo, trademark, or text.

Identification

Suggested name: Kidney

Suggested keywords: renal; organ; anatomy; body; urine; filtration; bean-shaped; kidney-shaped; stone; dialysis; transplant; donation

Suggested category: People & Body, body-parts

Suggested sort location: after `lungs` in the body-parts subgroup

The singular name `kidney` is the ordinary-language label and matches likely search behavior better than `kidneys`. The example image shows one kidney so that the silhouette, hilum, and urinary cue stay readable at emoji size.

Factors for Inclusion

A. Multiple meanings

Kidney carries a literal organ sense and an established non-medical shape sense. `Kidney-shaped` is ordinary design and retail vocabulary for kidney tables, kidney desks, kidney trays, and kidney-shaped swimming pools, used as a product category rather than as a figure of speech. See [1stDibs kidney-shaped tables](#) and [Houzz kidney-shaped pools](#).

The shape sense is not marginal. In the English Google Books corpus, `kidney-shaped` reaches a higher historical peak than `kidney stone` and remains near two-thirds of it in 2022. [Open the reproducible Ngram query](#).

The organ sense reaches everyday messages about a stone, a test result, dialysis, a transplant, and living donation. The shape sense is offered as an additional meaning, not as the basis for encoding.

B. Use in sequences

Kidney works as a building block with existing emoji. This proposal does not request a standardized sequence.

Message context	Composition
Anatomy or school science	Kidney plus book or microscope
Filtration or urine production	Kidney plus droplet
A personal or family health update	Kidney plus person
Donation or transplant	Kidney plus person and hospital

C. Breaks new ground

The [current Unicode Emoji List](#) has no Kidney character. Beans is the closest encoded pictograph and Unicode includes `kidney` among its search keywords, but its CLDR name is `beans` and it remains a Food & Drink pictograph. General medical emoji add a place, a treatment, or a test without naming the organ.

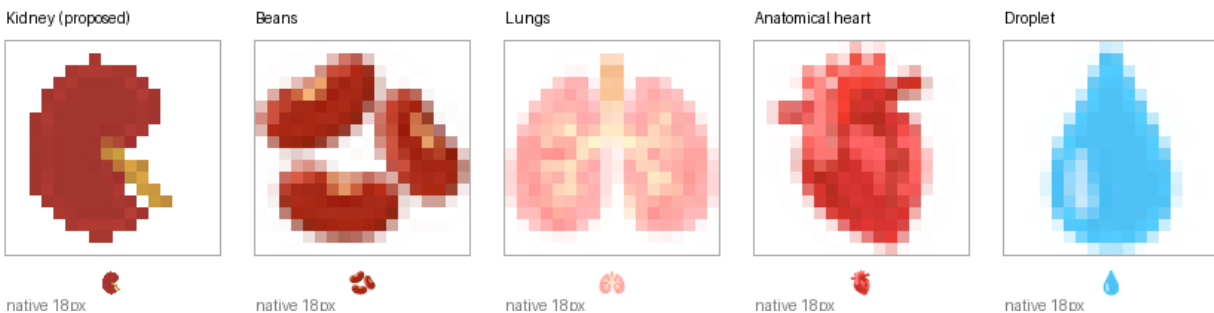
Existing emoji	Why it is insufficient
Beans	Displays and is named as food. It cannot tell a reader that a message concerns an organ.
Droplet	Reads as water, sweat, tears, or blood before it reads as urine or filtration.
Hospital, pill, syringe	Name a place, a treatment, or a procedure, not the organ involved.

D. Distinctiveness

The kidney has a distinctive form: a curved body, a medial hilum, and a short urinary cue. The example gives one organ most of the frame so the silhouette and hilum survive at 18x18. Vendors may vary color, shading, and anatomical detail while preserving the curved body, the hilum, and a short vessel or ureter cue.

Visual cue	Importance
Single curved body with a medial hilum	Required
A short vessel or ureter cue	Strongly preferred
Organ-like color	Optional
Fine vascular detail	Optional; removed at 18x18

The board below shows the proposed image at 18x18 beside Beans and the encoded organ pictographs it is most likely to be confused with, each at the same size and again at native scale.



Beans renders as several separate small forms, Lungs as symmetric paired lobes with a top-entering airway, and Droplet as a smooth teardrop. The single notched body with a short ureter is distinct from each.

E. Expected usage level

Writers already send a kidney pictograph. Lacking a Kidney character they substitute Beans: third-party emoji reference sites index Beans combinations under kidney and nephrology headings. See [Kidney emoji combinations](#). That is demand expressed pictographically rather than inferred from word counts.

Kidney also supplies the missing noun in ordinary messages. U.S. patient guidance uses the exact phrases `kidney stone`, `kidney tests`, `kidney transplant`, and `donate a kidney`; U.K. guidance uses `kidney transplant tests` and explains dialysis when kidneys can no longer filter normally. See [Kidney Stone Analysis](#), [Kidney Tests](#), [Kidney Transplant](#), and [Living Donation](#).

The five required exhibits below test the unfiltered term **kidney** against **elephant**. They are supporting context, not the primary case. The unfiltered term also captures **kidney bean** and disease pages, so these counts establish term visibility only.

Source	Query	Captured result	Reproducible URL
Google Search	kidney	About 211,000,000 results	https://www.google.com/search?q=kidney&hl=en&num=10&pws=0
Google Video Search	kidney	About 66,000,000 results	https://www.google.com/search?tbm=vid&q=kidney&hl=en&num=10&pws=0
Google Trends Web	elephant,kidney	See Figure 3	https://trends.google.com/trends/explore?date=all&q=elephant,kidney
Google Trends Image	elephant,kidney	See Figure 4	https://trends.google.com/trends/explore?date=all_2008&gprop=images&q=elephant,kidney
Google Books Ngram	elephant,kidney	See Figure 5	https://books.google.com/ngrams/graph?content=elephant%2Ckidney&year_start=1500&year_end=2019&corpus=en-2019&smoothing=3

Figure 1. Google Search results for kidney :

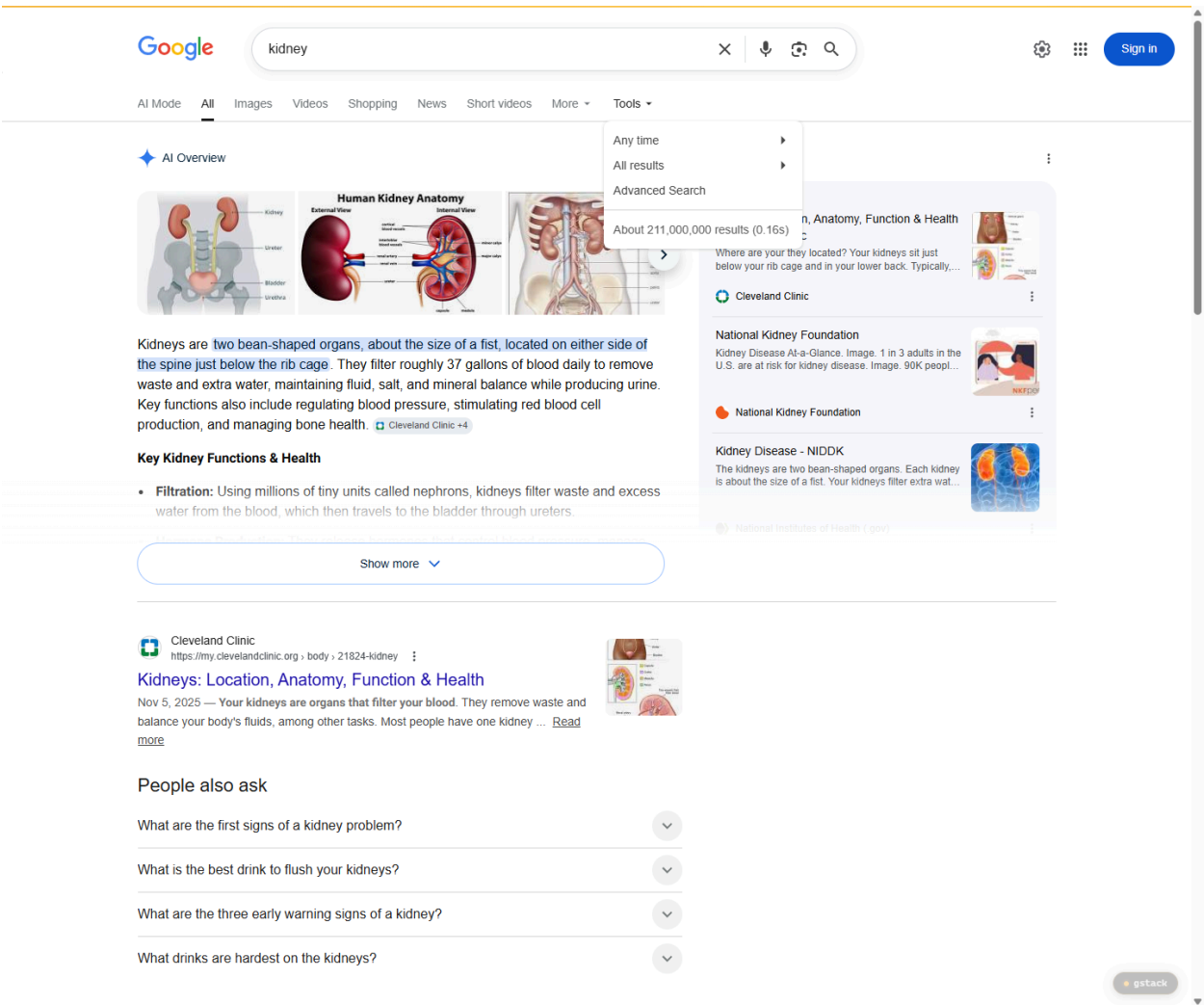


Figure 2. Google Video Search results for kidney :

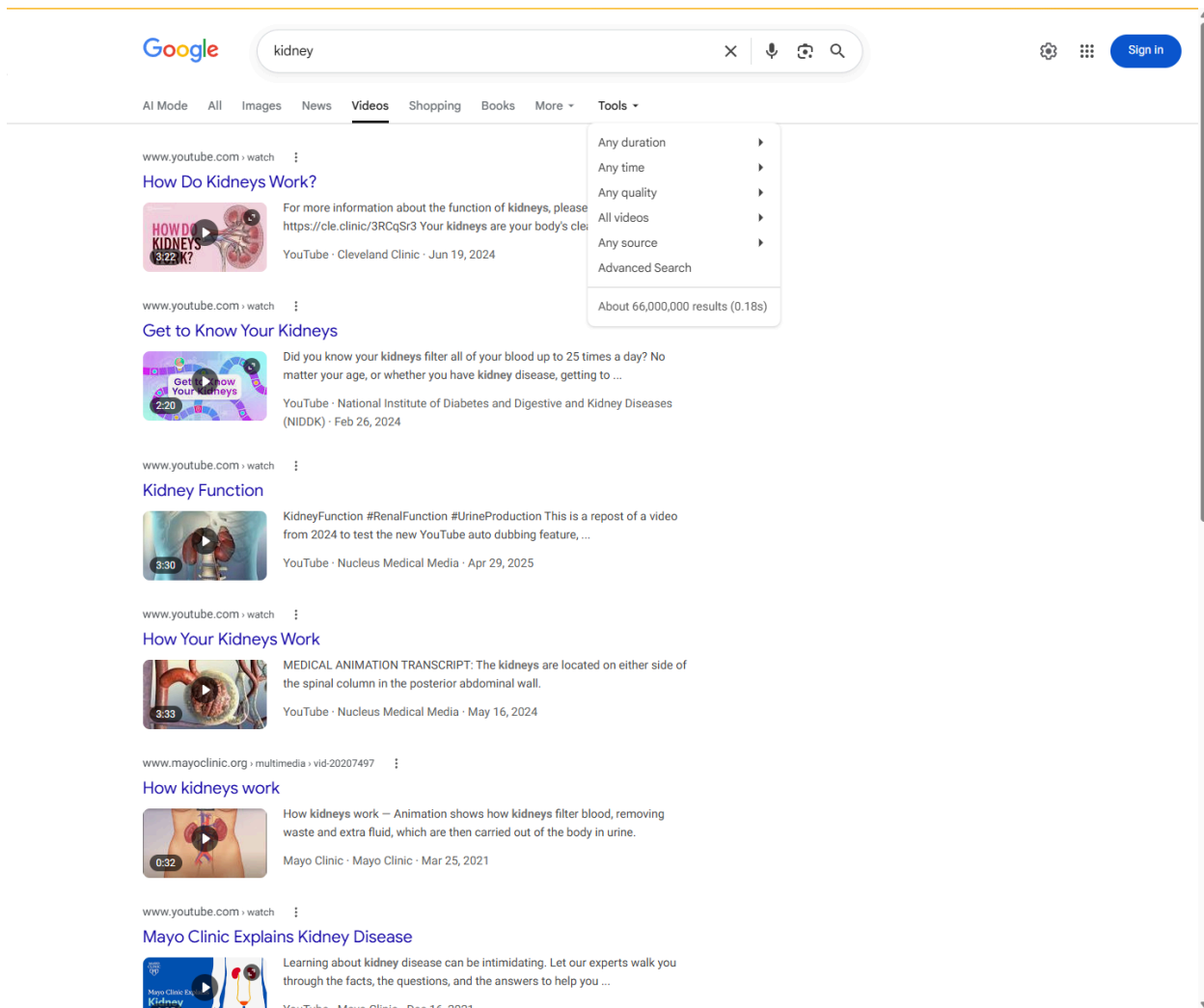


Figure 3. Google Trends Web Search, elephant versus kidney :

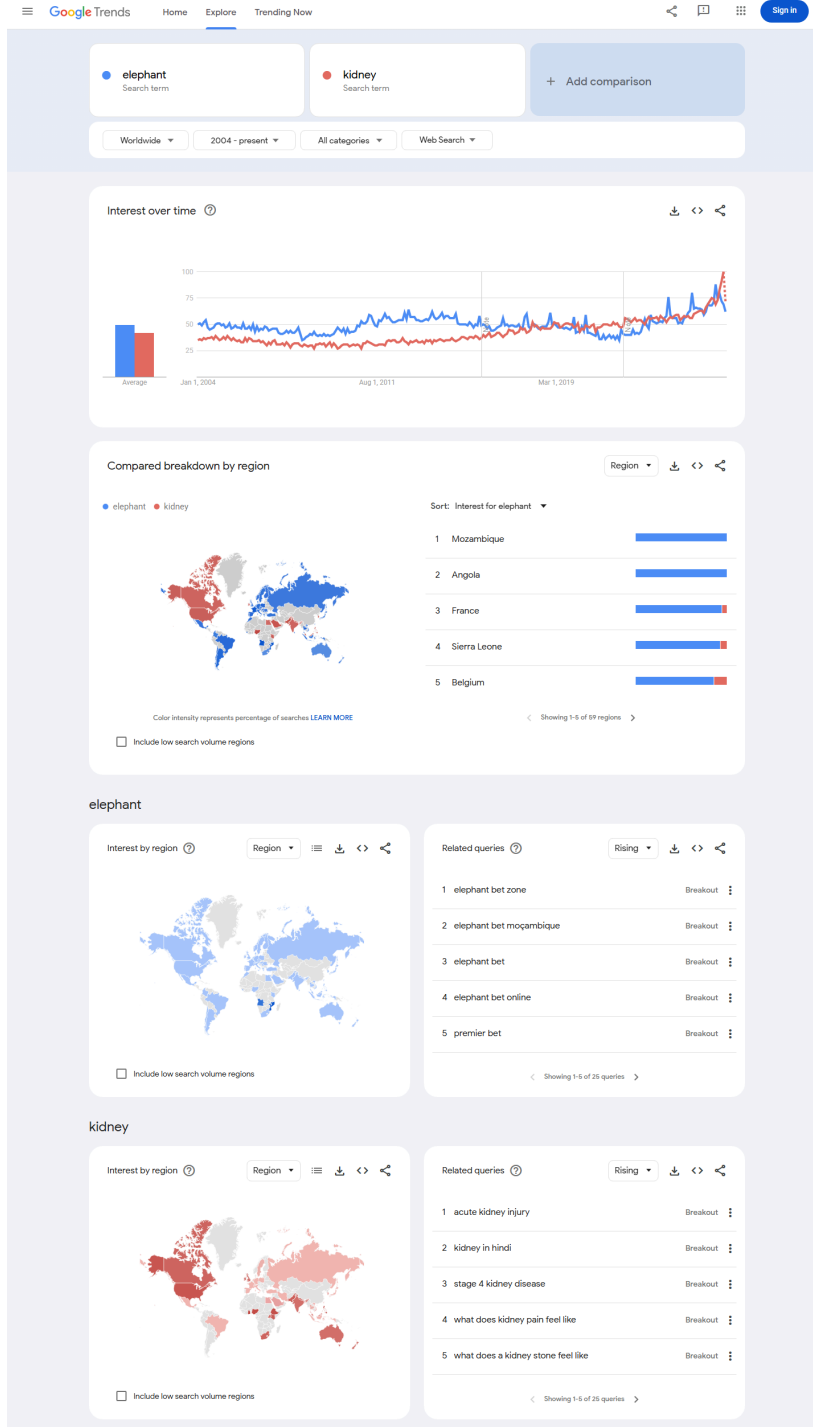


Figure 4. Google Trends Image Search, elephant versus kidney . Kidney remains below elephant for most of the displayed range:

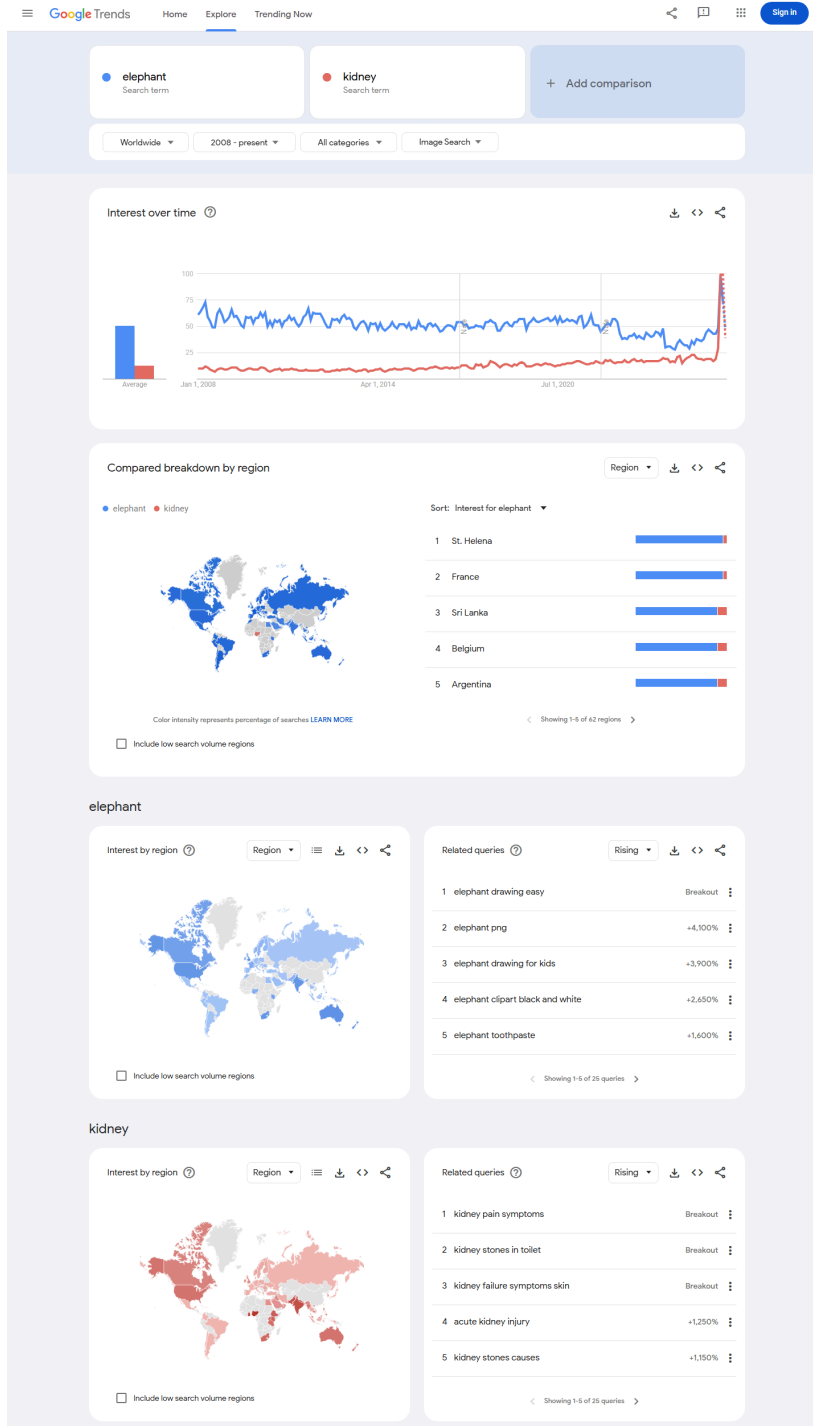
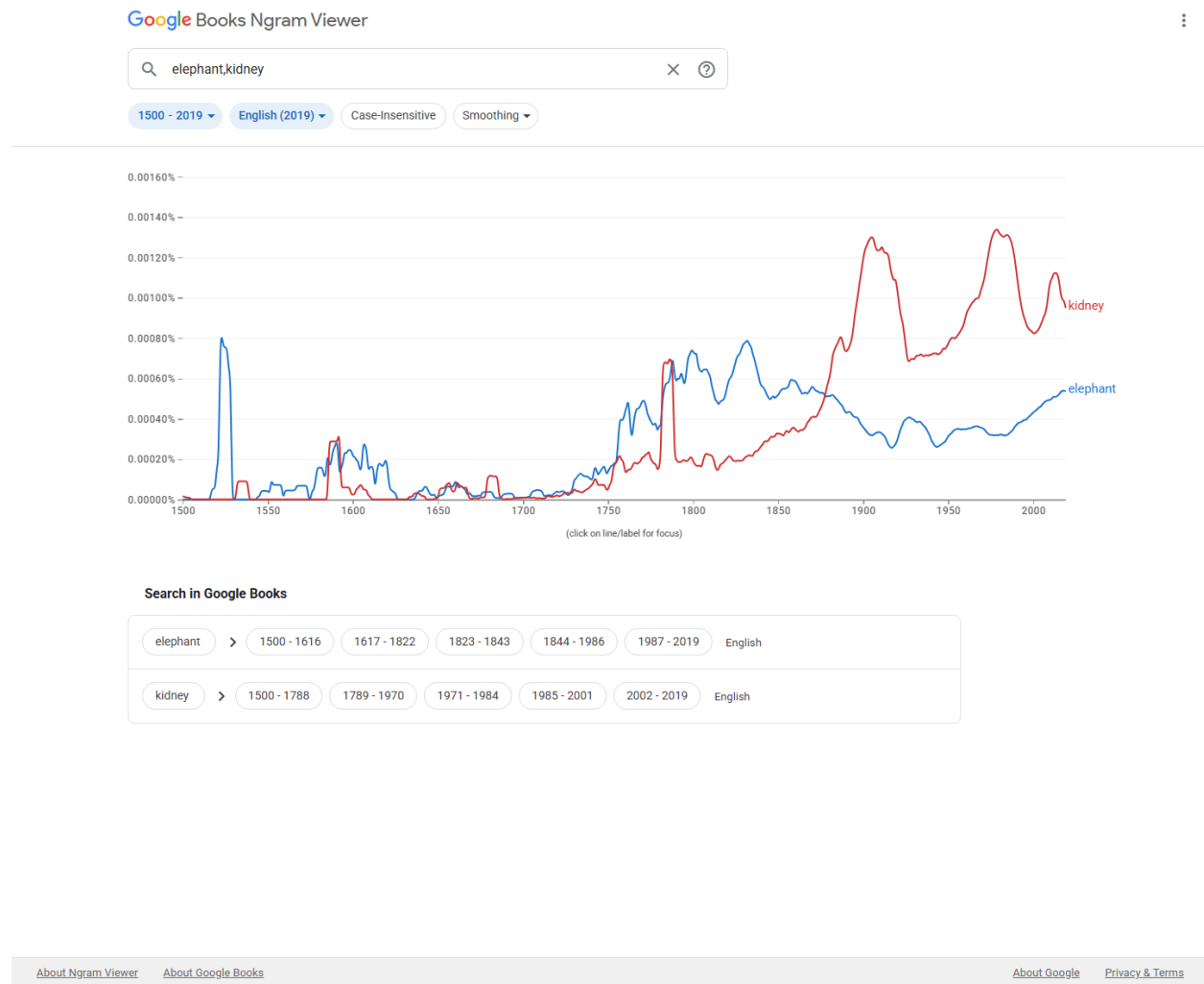


Figure 5. Google Books Ngram Viewer, elephant versus kidney :



F. Completeness

Not applicable. Internal organs are not a fixed set.

G. Compatibility

Not applicable. This proposal does not rely on a legacy carrier emoji or another encoded pictograph.

Factors for Exclusion

A. Already representable

Beans is the strongest existing substitute and is already used this way, which is the substance of this factor. The question is not whether a substitute can be improvised but whether it works. Beans is named `beans`, is categorized under Food & Drink, and displays food. Beans plus Hospital can suggest kidney care but reads equally as food, diet, or beans at a hospital. Beans plus Rock does not name `kidney stone`. In each case the reader must first assume that Beans means an organ.

B. Overly specific

Kidney represents the organ generally. The same noun spans stone analysis, testing, dialysis, transplantation, and living donation. It is not a disease, procedure, campaign, organization, or subtype.

C. Open-ended

The closest unencoded neighbours are Liver, Stomach, Pancreas, and Spleen. This proposal does not argue that any of them should follow, and it is not filed alongside them.

Kidney is proposed on a bounded rule: an established non-literal sense in ordinary English, a set of named everyday messages, an existing substitute that demonstrably fails, and a silhouette that stays legible at 18x18. Kidney is not the raw frequency leader among those neighbours; in English Books for 2013-2022, `stomach` and `liver` both exceed `kidney`. That is a concession, not a reason to reorder anything. Encoding Kidney would not establish that a neighbouring organ meets the same evidence, and each would have to make its own case.

D. Transient

Kidney is an established anatomical and everyday term rather than a campaign, event, or product. The Books evidence spans centuries and current patient guidance uses the same noun throughout.

E. Faulty comparison

Existing organ emoji do not create an entitlement to Kidney. Anatomical heart, lungs, and brain are used here only as small-size legibility comparisons. The Kidney case rests on its own shape sense, its named everyday messages, the failure of Beans, the frequency exhibits, and a pictograph that holds together at 18x18.

Other Information

The singular name Kidney identifies the organ concept while the example shows one kidney. This proposal does not request separate singular and plural characters. Vascular detail is omitted at 18x18, where it does not survive, and retained at 72x72.

Official Unicode proposal guidance:

<https://www.unicode.org/emoji/proposals.html>